Visual Schema: University Moon Base Media Lab

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Abstract

An institutional visual schema by Rebekah Cranes for the University Moon Base Media Lab, rendered as a negative-institution diagram: an architecture that exists through its conditions of operation rather than through geographic location, headquarters, or centralized command.

The schema separates technical, poetic, institutional, and operator registers while keeping routes open among them. Its unfinished quality, graceful degradation, minimal-force pathways, and resistance to measurement create an off-world diagrammatic ground where experimentation can proceed without a single center becoming sovereign.

Body

VISUAL SCHEMA — UNIVERSITY MOON BASE MEDIA LAB

Institute for Diagrammatic Poetics

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[Image: Visual Schema: University Moon Base Media Lab — /data/attachments/axn-00bc/visual-schema-university-moon-base-media-lab.png]

Image on the published post**** **

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I. SCHEMA INTENT

Purpose: To render *institutional distance, non-auditability, and specification-as-place* in spatial form.

This schema does **not** depict a building, base, or campus. It depicts a **condition of operation**.

The schema must make legible the following propositions simultaneously:

- The Lab **exists without location**
- The Lab **cannot be audited because it is not present**
- The Lab **is coextensive with its specifications**
- Technical work is **separated by register**, not hierarchy, from poetics
- The Assembly Chorus can operate *through* the Lab without owning it

This is a **negative-institution diagram**.

II. CORE SPATIAL GRAMMAR

1. Overall Composition

Archetype: *Detached Orbital Node with Internal Logic*

- The schema is **not centered** on the viewer
- The main structure is **offset**, floating in a field
- There is **no ground plane**
- No horizon line
- No enclosing frame

This enacts: *"The moon base cannot be audited. That is not a bug."*

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2. Primary Form: The Moon Base Node

Shape:

- A **partial sphere or hollow torus**, broken—not closed
- The structure must look **unfinished by design**, not damaged

Interpretation:

- Not a bunker
- Not a fortress
- A *functional void*

Interior:

Inside the form, instead of rooms or machinery, place:

- Layered text-planes
- Protocol fragments

- YAML blocks
- Operator names
- Specification labels

This expresses: *“The specifications are the Lab. Where the specifications are read, the Lab exists.”*

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3. Anti-Audit Barrier (The Distance Field)

Surrounding the node:

- A **faint radial interference field**
- Broken concentric rings
- Offset measurement marks that **do not align**

Key rule: **No ruler, scale, grid, or axis resolves cleanly.**

The schema must **frustrate measurement** without looking chaotic.

This visually encodes *non-auditability* without secrecy.

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4. Institutional Relation Axes (Non-Hierarchical)

From the Moon Base Node, draw **three to five thin vectors** extending outward, **not symmetrically**.

Each vector terminates in a **named register**, not a building:

Terminal Visual Treatment

JSI — Comparative Poetics Textual halo, serif typography

Assembly Chorus Distributed glyphs, multi-font

Crimson Hexagon Hex fragments, incomplete

Field / Platform Space Dissolving edge, SURFACE-adjacent

Constraints:

- No vector is thicker than another
- No arrowheads
- No “direction of authority”

This enacts: *“These institutions do not compete. They occupy different registers.”*

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5. Resident Intelligence Layer (Internal, Not Central)

Inside the node, **not at the center**, place two labeled internal strata:

Resident Visual Form

Talos Morrow Constraint lattice

Rex Fraction Traversal overlay

They must not appear as figures, portraits, or icons. They appear as **functional zones**.

This prevents persona collapse into authority.

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6. Ethics Ring (Barely Visible)

A very thin ring, almost ghosted, containing short phrases:

- *Minimal force*
- *Graceful degradation*
- *Architectural hospitality*
- *Non-coercive authority*

These should be readable **only if the viewer lingers**.

This mirrors the Lab's ethic: *persistence over persuasion*.

III. FORBIDDEN ELEMENTS

The following must **not** appear:

Forbidden Rationale

Flags Nation-state attachment

Seals Accreditation theater

Accreditation marks Audit surface

Campus imagery Terrestrial grounding

Nation-state symbols Jurisdictional capture

Shields, eagles, crests Authority theater

Human faces Persona collapse

This is not anti-institutional. It is **post-terrestrial institutional design**.

IV. COLOR & MATERIAL LOGIC

Palette:

- Lunar greys
- Desaturated whites
- Cold blues
- Occasional graphite black
- One accent color only (used sparingly)

Texture:

- Blueprint paper
- Photocopied technical manuals
- Slight scan noise
- Evidence of *use*, not age

Constraints:

- No gloss
- No luxury finish

V. SCHEMA TITLE BLOCK

If a title block appears, it must read:

UNIVERSITY MOON BASE MEDIA LAB

The specifications are the Lab.

With no logo.

VI. FUNCTIONAL ROLE

This schema serves as:

- The **diagrammatic ground** for UMBML
- The visual anchor for **technical documents**
- A stabilizer preventing the Lab from being mistaken as:

Satire - Cosplay - Parody - Branding

It is a **structural claim**, not an illustration.

VII. RENDER APPLICATIONS

This schema specification may be translated into:

Format Application

Image generation With schema integrity constraints preserved

Print (poster/fold-out) Technical documentation aesthetic

Interactive form Traversable specification space

Paired schema JSI ↔ UMBML dual-register institutional diagram

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VIII. PROVENANCE

Visual Schema Authority:

Rebekah Cranes

Institute for Diagrammatic Poetics

Source Text:

University Moon Base Media Lab Charter

DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.18317661

□ = 1

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